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HOUSES IN HAMPSTEAD
by **Francis Newton Souza**
Sold in **March 2025**
Price: **₹67.45 crore**

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UNTITLED (DIAGONAL)
by **Tyeb Mehta**
Sold in **April 2025**
Price: **₹61.8 crore**

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TRUSSED BULL
by **Tyeb Mehta**
Sold in **September 2025**
Price: **₹57.97 crore**

NOTE Prices include buyer's premium
SOURCE 360 ONE's The Collector's Guide 2026, Saffronart

the artist. An early Sakti Burman painting, estimated at ₹25–35 lakh, sold for ₹3.2 crore, while a Shyamal Dutta Ray-work fetched ₹1.04 crore against an estimate of ₹8–12 lakh, setting a world auction record for the artist," says Batra.

A clear evidence of improving valuations is the strength of bidding across price segments. Collectors are increasingly rewarding rarity, quality, and artistic significance across a wider range of artists.

Auction data for 2025 suggests that demand extends beyond the most expensive artworks. The ₹1-10 lakh segment recorded 1,699 lots sold, while there were buyers for 1,287 lots in the ₹10 lakh–₹1 crore category, per data from 360 ONE's The Collector's Guide 2026.

CHALLENGES REMAIN

Record prices alone cannot build a lasting market. That requires sustained patronage, institutions that nurture talent, and wider public access. As India's collector base expands, a parallel question is gaining importance: who will support artists and cultural institutions beyond the auction room?

For Kiran Nadar, Chairperson of the Kiran Nadar Museum of Art (KNMA), the answer lies in building cultural infrastructure that can serve generations.

"While market cycles are natural, it is important to look beyond the numbers and focus on building a sustainable ecosystem where artists are supported over the long term and collectors are engaging with the work for its artistic and cultural significance, not just its investment potential," she says.

Nadar's journey as an art collector began in the late 1980s when she started acquiring works for her home. That passion has evolved into a significant collection of over 17,000 pieces.